PAPERBOY

SATURDAY, NOVEMBER 7, 2026

A 165,000-job October flipped the Fed from holding to hiking, the chips that cratered on Thursday clawed back a third of it, and Paraguay removed, charged and replaced its president inside 48 hours.

AI

Both AI labs got marked down on the same Friday

WHAT HAPPENED

Bloomberg reported Friday that OpenAI has raised $11bn so far in a round valuing it at $1.25tn, expected to close within weeks and possibly totalling about $20bn — against the $30bn at $1.4tn it was reported in late September to be seeking (TechCrunch). The same morning, Bloomberg had prospective investors discussing an Anthropic IPO valuation of about $1.2tn to $1.3tn, down from the $1.4tn–$1.5tn investors had told bankers and from October talks that reached $2tn; the Wall Street Journal had three prospective investors saying pricing would be lower, one nearer $1tn. Anthropic declined to comment. Both stories are single-origin, and nothing is priced.

WHAT IT MEANS

The private marks were the one set of numbers the selloff could not touch, because nobody had to print them. They are now moving the same way as the public tape, and faster. A cut of a third or more on a valuation discussed five weeks ago is not a correction; it is a re-rating of the thesis.

WATCH NEXT

The listing is still expected before month-end but could slip.

Corporate AI spend has stopped growing, and cheap tokens are why

WHAT HAPPENED

Ramp’s card data shows token spend rose 42% month-on-month in July, then 1.5% across August and September combined and 8.9% in October (TechCrunch). Concentration is extreme: the top 1% of firms spend just under $10,000 per employee per month, the top 10% $600 to $1,000, the median firm $12 to $15. Ramp’s lead economist Ara Kharazian blames falling prices rather than falling usage — OpenAI halved API prices for GPT-6 Sol and Luna in September, and Anthropic’s cuts for Fable 5.1 and Opus 5.5 reduced revenue growth by about $600m, per a company filing. “You can use more AI, but use it for less.”

WHAT IT MEANS

This is one card issuer's proxy, not industry revenue. But it explains the week. Kharazian: “Almost the entire spend on AI is from venture-backed, high-growth tech companies” — and if that is the buyer base, a shock reaches all of it at once.

WATCH NEXT

Anthropic's S-1/A and its eventual pricing put audited revenue against this.

Crusoe hands its stalled Wyoming megaproject to Google

WHAT HAPPENED

Crusoe confirmed Friday that it has sold an unfinished data-centre project in south-eastern Wyoming to Google, which announced $17bn of planned investment in the campus a day earlier (TechCrunch). The price was not disclosed. Crusoe announced the project last year with Blackstone-backed Tallgrass, to scale eventually to 10 gigawatts; Google had tried and failed to sign on as a customer, and reportedly raised concerns about its cost and construction timeline. Crusoe itself is unhurt: valued at $30.9bn after a $3.9bn round in September, it is building separately for Microsoft, for Oracle and OpenAI at Abilene, and for Google in Texas.

WHAT IT MEANS

Gigawatt construction is harder than the announcements imply, and the firms that can absorb a delay are the ones with the balance sheets. Yardeni Research added a second constraint this week: “We view the political backlash as another constraint on AI investment, alongside financial and physical bottlenecks.”

WATCH NEXT

The $17bn is planned, not committed.

SEMICONDUCTORS

Chips recovered a third of Thursday, and Nvidia gave most of its bounce back

WHAT HAPPENED

The PHLX Semiconductor Index closed Friday at 9,390.25, up 379.11 points or 4.21% from Thursday's 9,011.14 (Nasdaq) — about a third of Thursday's 12.25% collapse, its worst day since March 2020. It never traded negative: the low was 9,221.35, the high 9,627.26. The fade mattered more than the level. At 9:36am ET Nvidia was up 6.17% and AMD 8.75%; by the close Nvidia held only 2.78%, at $186.64, while AMD extended to 11.04%, at $449.04. Intel closed up 7.71%, Micron 5.12%. In Taipei, which shut hours before the US jobs report, TSMC fell 4.69% to NT$2,135 after recovering from a 10% drop.

WHAT IT MEANS

A one-third retracement on a day with no new chip news is a bounce, not a repair. That Nvidia specifically could not hold a 6% gain through a session the rest of the sector spent rising is the tell.

WATCH NEXT

Thursday's close of 9,011.14 is the line; a second leg takes it out.

Taiwan cuts short-selling by 90% and turns on its stabilisation fund

WHAT HAPPENED

Taiwan's Financial Supervisory Commission announced after Friday's Taipei close that intraday short-sale order volume using borrowed shares will be capped at 3% of a stock's 30-day average daily volume, down from 30%, from Monday 9 November, and that the minimum margin for short selling rises to 130% from 90% (The Edge). The Ministry of Finance said the National Financial Stabilization Fund would deploy money "as conditions warrant", adding: "Continued selling by foreign investors has also pointed to a significant deterioration in market confidence." The TAIEX fell as much as 9% intraday and closed down 4.51% at 39,701.64, in bear-market territory, with TSMC the heaviest drag.

WHAT IT MEANS

A 90% cut to short-sale capacity is an administrative floor, and floors are a confidence signal in both directions — they stop the selling and they tell you how worried the regulator is. Taiwan last reached for this in 2025, during the tariff turmoil.

WATCH NEXT

Monday's Taipei open is the first test. No fund size has been confirmed.

Taiwan moves to make chip smuggling a ten-year crime

WHAT HAPPENED

Governing-party legislators have tabled Foreign Trade Act amendments banning the export of specified integrated circuits, wafer materials, components and chipmaking equipment to mainland China without approval, carrying up to ten years in prison and fines of NT$5m to NT$10m (about $155,000 to $310,000), the same penalties for routing controlled goods through a third country, and mandatory confiscation of illegal gains (Asia Times). The Legislative Yuan's economics committee held a hearing on Monday 2 November. Current rules restrict only 12 categories of fab equipment, and adding AI servers by public notice would cap sentences at five years — only a statute doubles it. In August, Keelung prosecutors indicted nine people, including staff at Nvidia's and Super Micro's local units, over 74 diverted Nvidia B300 servers.

WHAT IT MEANS

None of those nine faces an export charge. Prosecutors reached for breach of trust and document forgery because no export offence fitted, and that gap is the entire bill. Economy minister Kung Ming-hsin, in October: "Going forward, some of our measures on controlled items will correspond to American ones."

WATCH NEXT

The opposition KMT and TPP hold a majority between them and neither has stated a position, so passage is not assured.

BUSINESS

165,000 jobs flipped the Fed from holding to hiking

WHAT HAPPENED

October payrolls rose 165,000 against a consensus of 59,000 among economists surveyed by Dow Jones, with unemployment at 4.1% (BLS). August was revised up 53,000 to 186,000 and September up 31,000 to 60,000, a combined 84,000. Average hourly earnings rose 14 cents, or 0.4%, to $38.00 — up 3.1% over the year. The prior 12-month average was 48,000. CME's FedWatch put a quarter-point December increase at 76.8% after the release. The Fed held at 3.75–4% on 28 October after September's hike, and both dissenters that day wanted a rise. Michigan's preliminary November sentiment came in at 51.0 against October's 48.0, the highest since August.

WHAT IT MEANS

A labour market running at three times its trailing average, with wages at 3.1%, removes the last argument for patience. The Fed is now priced as a tightening central bank alongside the Bank of England, which raised to 4% on Thursday, and an ECB that has been tightening since September.

WATCH NEXT

FOMC 8–9 December; November payrolls on 4 December.

A violent week ended with a split tape

WHAT HAPPENED

Friday's closes: the S&P 500 at 7,376.86, up 23.13 or 0.31%; the Nasdaq Composite at 24,579.42, up 264.43 or 1.09%; the Dow at 51,285.73, down 237.33 or 0.46%; the Russell 2000 at 2,754.11, up 24.22 (The Closing Print). The VIX closed at 25.64, down 9.01%. Over the week the S&P lost 203.21 points, or 2.7%, the Nasdaq 3.4% and the Dow 0.9%; technology fell roughly 8% and energy roughly 11% to 12%, while communication services gained about 5%. Treasury yields rose: the two-year to 4.51% from 4.46%, the ten-year to 4.86%. The 20-year, at 5.29%, stayed above the 30-year's 5.26%. Europe's STOXX 600 fell 1% on Friday but is now ahead of the S&P 500 for the year, above 10% against just over 7%.

WHAT IT MEANS

The Dow falling while the Nasdaq rose is the week in miniature: rate-sensitive value sold off on the jobs number, the most beaten-up growth bounced. The 20s-30s inversion is the bond market saying the tightening is not finished.

WATCH NEXT

Berkshire Hathaway posts third-quarter results and its 10-Q at about 8am ET this morning. Cash and Treasury bills stood at $365.5bn on 30 June, against $397.4bn on 31 March.

Brent had its steepest week since the pandemic began

WHAT HAPPENED

Brent's January contract settled Friday at $98.32, up 0.03%, and WTI for December at $90.83, up 0.3% — a flat end to a collapse (Rigzone). Brent fell about 16% over the week, its steepest weekly percentage fall since the start of the pandemic and, in LSEG data going back to 1988, its largest weekly fall in dollar terms. WTI lost about 13%, its worst week since 2022. The cause was the war premium unwinding on hopes of US–Iran de-escalation, compounded by forced selling as tech equities fell. JPMorgan puts the surplus at 1.1m barrels a day in September, widening to 1.4m in October.

WHAT IT MEANS

A 16% week that ends flat was repricing, not supply. Rebecca Babin of CIBC Private Wealth: "Despite a steady stream of headlines, there has been little concrete evidence of meaningful diplomatic progress." If the diplomacy stalls, nothing structural holds the price down.

WATCH NEXT

Fresh US strikes on Qeshm Island on Friday cut against the de-escalation trade — see World Politics.

STARTUPS

Sequoia shuts the Scouts programme and closes London

WHAT HAPPENED

Sequoia said in a memo this week that it is shutting down the Scouts programme it pioneered about 17 years ago, and closing its London office (TechCrunch). It did not argue against the model, framing the decision as "putting more energy behind fewer people and things". Andreessen Horowitz is shrinking rather than killing its own network — partner Gabriel Vasquez: "They get more budget, but we have reduced the number." Roxanne Varza, who runs Station F and was a Sequoia scout from 2020 to 2025, said of the programme: "I believe they have helped to foster the investment culture and early-stage investment landscape."

WHAT IT MEANS

Scouts were how American capital found European founders before it had European offices. Closing the programme and the London office in the same week removes two early-stage sensors at once, and doing it mid-selloff says something about how the best-known firm in the business reads the next two years.

WATCH NEXT

Whether a16z's trimmed network goes the same way.

The Pentagon offers 6K a conditional $250m for a cathode plant

WHAT HAPPENED

Battery-materials company 6K has won conditional approval for a $250m federal loan to build a cathode-materials factory in Tennessee; the company’s own wording is “conditional commitment” (TechCrunch). No capacity, total project cost or city has been stated, and no office or programme is named — the coverage says only the Department of Defense while 6K’s release says Department of War. The plant was originally slated to open in 2024 and was delayed by a cancelled grant and uncertainty in the electric-vehicle market. There is no new opening date.

WHAT IT MEANS

Direct state credit is substituting for the grant programmes that were cancelled, and the terms are vaguer than a grant's. A conditional commitment is not money, and a factory with no stated capacity is not yet a factory.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the loan closes, and on what conditions.

Europe's week: EUR 1.3bn, and one very large battery deal

WHAT HAPPENED

Return, based in Amsterdam and Berlin, secured EUR 835m of portfolio financing to expand battery storage in Germany, underwritten by Deutsche Bank and Rabobank and structured to combine physical battery assets with its “Virtual Flexibility Portfolio” (company release). Initial coverage is 117MW across three projects under construction, and the company targets at least 1GW of German installation a year from 2027. This is debt, not equity. Elsewhere, one aggregator counts more than EUR 1.3bn across 60-plus European deals for the week; the rounds not previously carried here are Titan OS (EUR 41m, from BlackRock, Mangrove and Highland Europe), Braid (EUR 34.1m), Easol ($30m, a Series A extension), Samplix (EUR 25m first close), Tumbleweed (EUR 6.9m) and Conlio (EUR 6.4m).

WHAT IT MEANS

Grid flexibility is now financed like infrastructure rather than venture, which is what happens when the data centres everyone is building need somebody else to firm up the power. Note the lender names: this is bank paper, not fund money.

WATCH NEXT

Return's release is dated 4 November, and the aggregate is a single source's count with no date on any individual deal.

US

Stephen Miller takes over as chief of staff

WHAT HAPPENED

Trump announced on Truth Social on Friday that Stephen Miller, his deputy chief of staff, “will become the Chief of Staff starting Monday, November 9, 2026”, with Susie Wiles “moving over to the Trump Political Operation” (AP via PBS). Wiles posted: “Today is my last day as White House Chief of Staff”, adding that her commitment to the President and the mission was unchanged. CBS reported she submitted her resignation on Thursday night, tied to the midterm defeats. Trump told reporters: “Not because of the election. It’s just time.”

WHAT IT MEANS

Wiles was the operator who kept the building running; Miller is the ideologue who drove its most contested policy. Swapping the first for the second, with a Democratic Congress arriving in January, is a decision about what the remaining two years are for. In a 60 Minutes interview taped Friday morning, hours before the announcement, Ross Douthat asked Trump whether he expected to fire anyone: "I do, yeah. Little bit."

WATCH NEXT

The full interview airs Sunday 8 November at 7pm ET.

Two Senate seats still have no winner

WHAT HAPPENED

Nobody has called Mississippi or Alaska, the last two uncalled Senate races. In Mississippi, WLBT put Scott Colom ahead of Cindy Hyde-Smith by 2,029 votes — 467,153 to 465,124 — at an estimated 96.8% of expected vote on Friday afternoon (WLBT); AP’s snapshots that day differed slightly, so read the lead as about 2,000. Secretary of State Michael Watson counts roughly 3,600 outstanding mail ballots plus 12,000 to 20,000 affidavit ballots. Mississippi has no recount law at all. In Alaska, Peltola’s campaign sued the Division of Elections on Friday for records showing why each absentee ballot was rejected, and moved for a restraining order; no new tally has been published since 4 November and her lead stands at about 600.

WHAT IT MEANS

Both races now turn on administrative discretion over rejected ballots rather than on votes still to be counted, which is why both campaigns are in court or writing letters rather than canvassing. Hyde-Smith's campaign has issued statements in the third person; she has not spoken in her own voice since election night.

WATCH NEXT

Mississippi's mail grace period closes 10 November, counties certify by 13 November, the statewide declaration is due by 3 December. Alaska updates on 10 and 13 November, with ranked-choice tabulation on 18 November only if nobody clears 50%.

The Justice Department drops its California ballot suit

WHAT HAPPENED

The Justice Department moved on Friday to dismiss voluntarily its own suit seeking to set aside about 20,000 California ballots it alleged were cast by non-citizens — four days after the Supreme Court denied its emergency application, No. 26A624, on 2 November with no opinion and no noted dissents (CBS). The motion told Judge David O. Carter, in case 2:26-cv-12025-DOC-ADS: “The relief the United States sought and needed is no longer available—rendering voluntary dismissal necessary.”

WHAT IT MEANS

The relief expired because the election happened. The chronology shows what the suit was for: a 48-hour demand on 13 October, a filing on the 15th, denials at every level through 2 November. Bill Essayli, the senior federal prosecutor in Los Angeles, before the election: "We want to stop the illegal voting. We don’t want to chase it later."

WATCH NEXT

An evidentiary hearing on the reliability of the government's list had been set for 13 November. Nothing on the record says whether the dismissal is with or without prejudice, which decides whether it can be refiled.

WORLD POLITICS

Trump confirms new strikes on Qeshm as the maritime toll climbs

WHAT HAPPENED

Trump confirmed on Friday that the US had struck Iran’s Qeshm Island again, calling them “minor strikes” on an air-defence system knocked out in about fifteen minutes (Al Jazeera). CENTCOM called the situation “relatively calm”. Separately, the campaign’s first named seafarer death: the product tanker MT Velos Sapphire, Marshall Islands-flagged and Greek-managed, was hit overnight on 4–5 November about 50 nautical miles north of Madinat ash Shamal, Qatar — in the Gulf, not the Strait. UKMTO logged “two unidentified projectiles”; one crew member was killed. No party has claimed that vessel.

WHAT IT MEANS

The IMO's running count reached 129 incidents and 25 seafarer deaths by 6 November. Both sides are behaving as though a deal is close while the tempo on the water rises: the IRGC claimed on Friday that two tankers caught fire on mines and Iran's navy claimed another on Saturday — all unnamed, all a party describing its own operations, none confirmed.

WATCH NEXT

Qatar's prime minister, at Oxford: “We will never have a perfect peace deal but you can’t wait for that perfect moment.”

Paraguay removed, charged and replaced its president in 48 hours

WHAT HAPPENED

Paraguay’s Senate removed President Santiago Peña on Friday — 44 of 45 senators, all those present, after a ten-hour trial (MercoPress). Deputies had impeached him on Thursday, 78-0 among those present. Pedro Alliana, 52, his vice-president, was sworn in the same day. A prosecutor then ordered Peña detained at home on suspicion of breach of trust, influence peddling and self-serving administration. He had offered to resign, but the session to accept it lacked a quorum — so he was impeached instead, forfeiting the lifetime Senate seat and immunity a resignation would have carried.

WHAT IT MEANS

The trigger was Tuesday's pre-dawn seizure of Ueno, a digital lender with about three million members — roughly two-thirds of Paraguayan adults — which the central bank said had fallen below legal solvency standards. It grew on more than $800m of public money, legislators accuse Peña of letting the state pension fund deposit about $355m beyond legal limits, and at least 27 people face charges. An arrest warrant was issued for the former central bank governor, whom Peña appointed in 2023 after he had run the finance company that became Ueno.

WATCH NEXT

Alliana serves to 15 August 2028 and comes from Peña's own Colorado Party, whose leader Horacio Cartes backed the impeachment “in order to restore the republic’s institutions”.

Thirty-six ballistic missiles at Kyiv, three days before Abu Dhabi

WHAT HAPPENED

Russia launched 172 long-range attack drones overnight into Saturday, 137 of them jet-powered, alongside Iskander-M, Zircon and KN-23 missiles; Ukraine's air force said it downed 149 drones and four missiles, with impacts at 24 locations (Kyiv Independent). Zelensky said 36 ballistic missiles were fired, all at Kyiv and the surrounding region. A substation in Kyiv oblast linking the Rivne and Khmelnytskyi nuclear plants to the capital and central Ukraine was hit, with others damaged in five more oblasts. At least two people were killed and 37 injured nationally.

WHAT IT MEANS

Hitting the substation that connects two nuclear plants to Kyiv is grid warfare aimed at the winter, and the timing is the message. Zelensky: "The capital is facing serious difficulties with its electricity, water, and heat supplies", and "Russia is preparing for trilateral talks by launching ballistic missiles at Ukraine's critical infrastructure."

WATCH NEXT

US, Ukrainian and Russian delegations meet in Abu Dhabi from Tuesday 10 November, expected to run two days.

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TechCrunch — Pentagon offers 6K a $250m loan

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